University of Colombo School of Computing

Internal Undergraduate Degrees

Course Detail Document

Course Outline

Course Code:	IS1203								
Course Name:	Foundations of Information Systems								
(Bold and underline the appropriate)	**Year:**	**1**	2	3	4		**Semester:**	**1**	2
Number of Credits:	02								
Core/Optional:	Core								
Evaluation Criteria:	**Assignments:**	20%							
	Final Exam:	80%							
Course Prerequisites	N/A								

		Per Week	**Total**
Method of Delivery:	**Lectures**	2 hours	30 hours
	Tutorials (not pre-scheduled)	-	40 hours
	Lab Work	-	-
	Group Work (not pre-scheduled)	-	30 hours

Course Definition

Introduction	This course covers basic concepts of information systems, and it enables the students to develop their understanding of the computer-based information systems' components, functions and roles in organisations. The students will study different types of business information systems, their acquisition process and the management challenges associated with their use.
Course Learning Outcomes:	Upon completion of this course, students will be able to do the following: **LO1**. Identify the information system requirements. **LO2**. Identify the components, characteristics, value-added processes, and the role of an organisational information system. **LO3**. Analyse functions, components and important characteristics of different information systems in an organisation. **LO4**. Evaluate information technology/system acquisition options and performance. **LO5**: Describe how to acquire IT infrastructure, IS resources and capabilities.

	LO6. Describe how to mitigate the issues related to information systems usage, operation and development.
Assessment Plan	In-class assignments: **LO1** to **LO3** - 10% In-class assignments: **LO4** to **LO6** - 10%
References/Reading Materials	• Stair, R., Reynolds, G. "Principles of Information Systems" 9th Edition, Thomson Course Technology • Laudon K., Laudon J. "Management Information Systems" 13th Edition, Pearson Education Limited

Course Content

Topic 1: Introduction to Information Systems

- Data Vs. Information
- Quality of Data and Information
- Components of an Information System (IS) and a Computer Based Information System (CBIS)
- Information System Careers and Challenges Faced

Duration: 4 hrs

Topic 2: Information Systems in Organizations

- Role of IS in Business
- Value Chain of an Organisation
- Organisational Structure, Culture, Values and Change
- Business Process Re-engineering and Continuous Improvement
- Gaining Competitive Advantage

Duration: 6 hrs

Topic 3: Different Types of Business Information Systems

- Functional Information systems
- Transaction Processing System (TPS)
- Management Information Systems (MIS)
- Decision Support Systems (DSS),
- Executive Support Systems (ESS)
- Enterprise Applications

Duration: 6 hrs

Topic 4: Acquiring IT/IS Infrastructure Capabilities and Performance Evaluation

- IT/IS Infrastructure
- Business Value of IS
- IS Infrastructure and Service Acquiring Process
- Souring and Outsourcing IS Services and Applications
- IT/IS Performance Evaluation and Management

Duration: 6 hrs

Topic 5: Social and Ethical Issues Related to Information Systems

- Computer-Related Wastes and Mistakes
- Computer Crimes
- Ethics in Information Society
- Moral Dimensions of the Information Age
- Security Management

Duration: 4 hrs

Course Administration Details			
Lecturer in-charge	Dr. Thushani A.Weerasinghe		
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